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Hearing Set for June 29 On Sunro Mine Appeal

The Pollution Control Board will hear on June 29 the appeal of a mine company near Jordan River which has been refused a permit to discharge tailings into Juan de Fuca Strait.

The hearing will open at 10 a.m. in room 104 of the Provincial Museum and while the public can attend, only the nine parties which have qualified as objectors will be heard besides the company.

The Pollution Control Branch declined to identify the nine objectors today because letters advising them of the appeal have just gone out. Their names will be available Friday.

The appeal has been launched on behalf of Sunro mine which last week learned that its application to discharge up to a million gallons daily of mine tailings from a pipe just below the low tide line had been refused by William Venables, the province's director of pollution control.

While some residents near Jordan River, commercial fishermen and conservationists are among those who opposed the application, wording of the announcement from the PCB last week hinted that confidential recommendations from two government departments — health, and recreation and conservation — had been major factors in Venables' decision.

On the latter point, E. C. Dobell, vice-president of Crownex International, said today the two departments had not seen the explanatory material the company had forwarded to the PCB with its application, even though a company officer had checked more than once to see if it had been passed along.

A spokesman for the PCB refused to confirm or deny this, saying there would be no comment because the case was subjudice, active and unresolved before the judicial process.

The Pollution Control Board is a six-member body to which appeals can be made from decisions of the Pollution Control Branch. Its decisions in turn can be appealed to either the cabinet or the provincial supreme court.

Board chairman is Valter Raudsepp, deputy minister of water resources. Other members are Dr. J. A. Taylor, deputy minister of health; R. G. McMynn, director of commercial fisheries, department of recreation and conservation; J. W. Peck, chief inspector of mines; Dr. C. J. G. Mackenzie from the medical faculty at UBC and James Allin, department of agriculture.

LOCAL SHIP MOVEMENTS

DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORT

Camsell and Vancouver in port, Racer en route to Kitsilano, Douglas southbound on east coast of Vancouver Island, Ready in Rivers Inlet patrol area, Quadra on Station Papa, Rider in Tofino patrol area.

NAVY

Qu'Appelle at Port Alberni, return date not listed; Laymore at sea, return date not listed; Columbia, Rainbow, Cowichan, Miramichi, Fundy and Chignecto at sea, returning June 14.

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